

Acme Corp - HR Policy Manual v3.2

1. Annual & Sick Leave

All full-time employees are entitled to 20 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Leave accrues at 1.67 days per month and unused leave may be carried forward up to 5 days. Sick leave is capped at 10 days per year; a medical certificate is required for absences exceeding 3 consecutive days. Leave requests must be submitted via the HR portal at least 5 business days in advance for planned absences.

2. Maternity & Paternity Leave

Primary caregivers are entitled to 16 weeks of fully paid maternity leave, extendable by 4 weeks unpaid. Secondary caregivers (paternity leave) receive 4 weeks of fully paid leave within the first 12 months after birth or adoption. Shared parental leave allows couples to split up to 37 weeks of paid leave between them. Employees must notify HR at least 8 weeks before the expected leave start date.

3. Remote Work Policy

Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week, subject to manager approval. Remote work is not permitted during the first 90 days of employment. All remote workers must maintain a secure home office environment and connect via the company VPN. Core hours for collaboration are 10:00-15:00 in the employee's local timezone. Equipment allowance: up to \$500 for home office setup, reimbursed upon submission of receipts.

4. Performance Reviews

Formal performance reviews are conducted bi-annually: mid-year in June and end-of-year in December. Each review includes a self-assessment, peer feedback (360 degrees), and manager evaluation. Ratings: Exceptional (5), Exceeds Expectations (4), Meets Expectations (3), Needs Improvement (2), Unsatisfactory (1). Employees rated Exceptional or Exceeds Expectations are eligible for discretionary bonuses of 10-20% of base salary. Performance Improvement Plans (PIPs) are issued when an employee receives two consecutive Needs Improvement ratings.

5. Code of Conduct

All employees must act with integrity, respect colleagues, and protect company assets. Harassment, discrimination, and retaliation are strictly prohibited and may result in immediate termination. Conflicts of interest must be declared to the Ethics Committee within 5 business days of arising. Confidential company information must not be shared outside the organisation without written authorisation. Violations should be reported to hr@acmecorp.com or via the anonymous ethics hotline: 1-800-ETHICS.

6. Expense Reimbursement

Business expenses up to \$100 require manager approval and must be submitted within 30 days. Expenses between \$100 and \$500 require manager and finance approval. Expenses exceeding \$500 require VP-level approval plus finance sign-off. Travel expenses: economy class for flights under 6 hours; business class permitted for longer journeys. Expense reports must include original receipts and a brief business justification.